

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] Okay, Cool.

Speaker 1 [00:00:05] Okay. So hi. Thank you so much for participating in this interview, as I mentioned, over text and email. We want to know more about your views on romantic relationships, and we believe your experience and perspective would bring much this project. I really ask before I start recording, but I need to ask again for the recording. Is it all right if we record this interview? It will only be used for transcription and notetaking.

Speaker 2 [00:00:33] Yes, It's all right.

Speaker 1 [00:00:36] Okay. Awesome. Cool. Okay, so just starting with some demographic questions. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:45] I'm [21–25].

Speaker 1 [00:00:47] Nice. How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:51] We've been together for [<1 year].

Speaker 1 [00:00:54] Nice. And do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:58] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:59] And who lives in your household?

Speaker 2 [00:01:02] My partner.

Speaker 1 [00:01:04] Awesome. And what is your main source of income and what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:11] I'm currently a [occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:01:15] And how would you like us to address your partner? It's a lot different ways to do it by their name, any of those kind of things. But partner also works, if that's what you're comfortable with.

Speaker 2 [00:01:25] Well, yeah, a partner. Girlfriend. She/her they/them. [Partner Name] Yeah, it's all good..

Speaker 1 [00:01:36] I'm hearing, like, all the above. Okay, Awesome. Awesome. Okay, so that's enough of the demographic questions. Just for some context setting, could you tell me about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:01:55] Yeah. So we technically well, during like COVID shutdowns, we actually met online through mutual friend and we talked a little bit on there just a couple of times. But then we met through a mutual friend and we got introduced to each other that way. And like the first day that we actually saw each other, like in person, we just like, clicked and like I ended up going over in, like, spend all night with her and like, I don't know, not, looking back.

Speaker 1 [00:02:32] Awesome. That's great. And shifting gears a little bit, again, how would you compare the quality of your current relationship to that of your friends relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:50] Comparing my relationship with my friend [Name]. I mean, I was better than some of my friends relationships, for sure, but I'd say like pretty on par with some of my other friends relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:03:04] Yeah, that makes sense. And that's good. And can, can you tell me how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:03:16] I'd. It's like [1-5] romantic partners. Yeah, I not a ton.

Speaker 1 [00:03:26] Yeah. And how would you compare the quality of your current relationship compared to that of your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:03:35] So much better. It feels like I'm with somebody who, like, finally just, like, actually gets me in, like, every way. Not just most of them.

Speaker 1 [00:03:49] Yeah, I love that. And for you, what makes a relationship high or low quality? And why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:03:59] I mean, I would say it's a high quality relationship if you two are still, like encouraging positive growth in one another. I put that as like a. Pretty like positive relationship, kind of like the goal. This is like continuously learning and growing with each other. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:04:22] And what about like, what makes a relationship lower quality?

Speaker 2 [00:04:31] Just not communicating and and not really like. Thinking about how things will affect your partner before doing that. I feel like I see a lot and like ah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:04:51] And you just mentioned communication. Why do you think communication is important for a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:05:00] I mean, it's really easy to get mad about something when you are just confused and caught off guard and you have no clue what's going on. You know, like, that has to be one of the most frustrating situations to be put in. And if somebody is not communicating with you like that's just the situation they keep putting you in over and over again, This is like, wait, what? I don't know what's going on. Well, it's not very fun, especially when it's supposed to be your safe person. That's like they're for you, supposed to feel like home and safe and like, I know what's happening here, but.

Speaker 1 [00:05:34] Yeah, absolutely. Absolutely. And when would you say you had good communication and what happened then?

Speaker 2 [00:05:44] like an example of when I've had good communication. good question. Probably we had some so done, and I definitely had good communication when we decided to move in together because that was quite a process. She was going to be living down in [Region] and be relatively like. Oh away from her phone and hard to contact for like most of the summer. And so, like, we had to be like, really, really good at communication before she, like, left. And when we did have the ability to communicate

with each other, just making sure like we had everything set straight. We were both on the same page all the time. And that definitely made that process a whole lot easier on my end, for sure.

Speaker 1 [00:06:39] Yeah. Yeah, that makes sense. Awesome. And for you, what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:06:49] Definitely communication. I feel like it's something that everybody says. Like I really just need my partner to, like, talk to me and just be able to be honest with me because like, I know I'm not a scary person. I'm not going to yell at you. I just want to know what's going on. Like, that's all I ever ask for is is like, just tell me what's happening, and then we can deal with whatever that means.

Speaker 1 [00:07:18] Yeah, absolutely. And yeah, you seem like a very sweet and approachable person. So, um.

Speaker 2 [00:07:25] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:07:26] Um. And for you, it's a broad question, but for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:07:37] I think love is really just like. Putting your putting. Like that person over yourself and like anything else, especially things that are important to you. Like, I feel like that's like, really love is when, like. You care about this person so much that you're like, okay, I can set aside some of these things like make time, make room like. I don't know.

Speaker 1 [00:08:10] Yeah, it's a difficult question.

Speaker 2 [00:08:12] It's definitely a difficult question.

Speaker 1 [00:08:18] And how important is love in a relationship, do you think?

Speaker 2 [00:08:22] So important. I mean. If you're not doing it for love, then like, why even bother? I guess to me that just seems like a whole lot of work. We're not. Not a whole lot of benefit.

Speaker 1 [00:08:39] Yeah, absolutely. Absolutely. And how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:08:51] I'm sorry. You cut out.

Speaker 1 [00:08:52] Oh, sorry. My bad. How do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:08:59] I mean, she tells me, like every day. So that definitely helps. But I definitely, like, just like the little things that she does, like making me coffee in the morning and like making dinner when I come home from work or, like, I don't know, just like buying my favorite snack at the store sometimes. Just like, just all the little things I feel like is where you really see that stuff the most.

Speaker 1 [00:09:27] Yeah, that makes a lot of sense. And what would you say are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:09:35] Challenges. It was we were long distance for all of it up until we moved in together. And that was definitely pretty challenging because I didn't necessarily want to be in a long distance relationship. It hadn't been what I was looking for, but like. I just found someone who was like, very, very worth sticking it through and just like, seeing where it goes.

Speaker 1 [00:10:05] Yeah. Yeah. And do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:10:12] No, not really. I'd say like that sometimes we have, like disagreements about things where we don't quite agree on something, but it's usually just then a conversation of like, Oh, why do you feel that way? Oh, that's interesting. How do we fix this? Like, yeah, we can. We haven't really been in an argument that I can think of.

Speaker 1 [00:10:33] Yeah, that's awesome. And when you do, like, disagree, what are your I mean, I guess you said, like, the not really argument, but what are your disagreements about?

Speaker 2 [00:10:44] Mm. There's not a ton of them. Honestly, we've been doing pretty well. Like you're trying to figure out what to do with our living room. Space is like a big debate right now. Or just like. Do we want to get a couch or do we want to just do a bunch of fun pillows on the floor? Like, what are we really looking for? Like, what do we want to do? And I'm kind of leaning more towards maybe we get a little couch sleeping to more towards, like, fun alternative seating.

Speaker 1 [00:11:23] That's so funny. Yeah. And when you do have, like, a disagreement. How long was that disagreement last? I know. Like, right now, you said, like. So if you put random beeps on my computer. But anyways.

Speaker 2 [00:11:36] I think.

Speaker 1 [00:11:38] Yeah, go ahead. Go ahead.

Speaker 1 [00:11:40] Sorry. You know you're all right in trying to remember what you asked.

Speaker 1 [00:11:50] I said, How long do your like, disagreements last?

Speaker 2 [00:11:56] I say they usually last for like the duration of the conversation should. It's like we are usually same page just after talking to each other, like we really don't have any, like huge disagreements. I haven't run into a whole lot of that yet. But like, yeah. You know, at most, like. Maybe it'll drag on for, like, a couple of days. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:12:27] And how often would you say, like you guys disagree or, like, have disagreements with each other?

Speaker 2 [00:12:35] And almost never. Like, honestly, like something like, serious enough to, like, have a debate over something like that. It's usually never quite that serious. I don't think we're like, quite that serious about a lot of things in general. I guess we're just kind of pretty chill. Go with the flow, like, All right, go. It can work with this, which is it makes it a lot easier.

Speaker 1 [00:12:58] Yeah, but I guess it does make things a lot easier. Um, and like, if you do have a disagreement, we're like, yeah, disagreeing about something. How do you usually resolve that? Did I cut out again. I'm sorry.

Speaker 2 [00:13:17] Did you ask how we resolve that?

Speaker 1 [00:13:19] Yes. Yes, Sorry.

Speaker 2 [00:13:25] Okay. I know you're right. Yeah, just talking. We just talk about it. Just try to. Understand why the other person is thinking that way. Or like where they're coming from.

Speaker 1 [00:13:42] Yeah. Yeah, absolutely. And aside from communication and like talking things out, what are some other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:58] I think that like, yeah, just like those little acts of service are definitely a good way of just like maintaining the relationship because, you know, like how much effort does it take for you to like, brew an extra cup of coffee in the morning or something like that? Like just those little things like, like really, really go a long way. Just like they mentioned, they kind of want the dishes done, but like, I'll just go ahead. I'll get it. But like, I'll just do that. Make sure they Don't not to worry about. Like, it's this goes a long way. Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:14:33] Absolutely. And. Would you say that your relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:41] Yeah, I'd say this is definitely like. But the healthiest relationship I've ever been in. And it's been incredible for me. As just like just a human being. I feel like I've grown so much and it's like brought me out of a pretty dark place in my life, honestly. So like, been quite a bit of growing. It's been awesome.

Speaker 1 [00:15:02] That is so awesome. I'm glad to hear that. And actually kind of leads me to my next question. Did the relationship change you and in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:15:12] Uh, yeah, I would say that it's definitely changed me. I'd say it's made me possibly like, ah, a more open minded person when it comes to like, just like what a relationship means, honestly. Like, I think just kind of the way that we started it just kind of had anything like, okay, like, what am I actually looking for in a relationship? What does this actually mean to me? And I really had to look at that at like the beginning of our relationship. And so I think that alone changed. But I think I've definitely become like a lot more outgoing and adventurous and like, more willing to like, do things, which is something that I've been like trying to do for a long time. And [Partner's Name] has just been like super helpful and comforting whenever like we go out and do new things.

Speaker 1 [00:16:04] Yeah. That's so awesome. And what about [Partner's Name]? Do you think [Partner's Name] changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:15] I mean, yeah, yeah. [Partner's Name]'s definitely changed, like getting an extension until now. But like, I'd say, like, we've both just been growing in, like, pretty good ways and I can't think of, like, anything specifically like, Oh yeah, she's changed this way or something like that. But like, I just know that we've just both kind of

been on that journey and like, just been growing. Just from exploring and just learning about life. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:16:44] Yeah, That's great. And do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:50] Yeah. I feel really safe.

Speaker 1 [00:16:53] Yeah. And why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:16:57] I'd say, that I definitely grew up in a home where, like, I thought I knew what it meant to feel like safe and protected by the people who love you and stuff. And then uh. And then, like, I had a few relationships when I was like eh. And then I met [Partner's Name] and then, like, you know, just like the way that she takes care of me when, like, I would go stay over at her house and stuff like that and like these little efforts and things like that. I just like. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:17:38] Yeah. Yeah. That was really sweet. Awesome. So the next part of our interview is going to use, like, a likert scale, which is like a scale where you kind of say, like, one end is like, strongly disagree and the other is like, strongly agree. You've probably seen the scale where you like, pick like the number. Yeah. So I'm going to share my screen.

Speaker 1 [00:17:58] Pick your number, right? Let me just make sure I'm okay. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:18:03] Cool.

Speaker 1 [00:18:07] Okay. Can you see this?

Speaker 2 [00:18:11] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:18:12] I am going to make it into a slideshow because it's easier to see that way. But yeah, the question is, my partner usually really listens to me. So what do you think he would be like on this scale?

Speaker 2 [00:18:25] Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:18:27] Nine. Awesome. And why not like seven or eight?

Speaker 2 [00:18:33] I have just, you know, I've really just never had an instance where I was just like. Are you paying attention? Like, what's going on? Like, usually if we don't want to pay attention to each other, like, we're just like, I'm going to go play video games. I'm going to go do this. So it makes it a lot easier, I think, to feel like I'm being listened to when I'm talking to her. It's like she's ready for it.

Speaker 1 [00:18:58] Yeah. Yeah. And then the next question is, my partner usually is responsive to my needs. So what do you what number would you pick on the scale?

Speaker 2 [00:19:09] Uh, yeah, I'd say like a seven or eight. Like, pretty good about it.

Speaker 1 [00:19:15] Yeah. And why not like six or nine or seven or I guess you said eight. So like six or nine.

Speaker 2 [00:19:27] I mean, like, I don't know. Yeah, she's a human. There's certainly some times where. She. Yeah. Puts her needs over mine like that happened. So I can't be, like, absolutely perfect. Yeah, it seems a little unfair, but like, also, like, I mean, she's very, very responsive to my needs. And I was sick the other day, and like, she took great care of me, like. I definitely couldn't say it's any less than very true.

Speaker 1 [00:20:01] Yeah, absolutely. That is amazing. I'm glad you guys have that going.

Speaker 1 [00:20:09] No. Okay. There you go. Sorry. So I don't know why, but the.

Speaker 1 [00:20:12] The.

Speaker 1 [00:20:13] The slides are weird sometimes, anyway. Okay, so how about this question? How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:20:22] Well, I would say that I'm completely satisfied right now.

Speaker 1 [00:20:26] Awesome. Okay. And then what about, like, the scale? Like, how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:20:36] I've made it out of ten right now. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:20:38] Awesome. Awesome.

Speaker 2 [00:20:39] I'm real happy with it.

Speaker 1 [00:20:41] Yeah. Yeah. And then why not like a nine or eight? I know I keep asking you like the numbers, but.

Speaker 2 [00:20:52] I just, I, I personally, I can't think of anything that either of us could do to make our current relationship any better. Like, I feel like we're both on the same, you know, like, kind of like path, I guess. Like we both got like similar places that we're shooting for Things we want to do with our lives right now. Like there's not really anything where I'm like, Oh, I don't know about how that's going to go or anything like that. Like, we just moved in together and we've been really, really happy about it. It's been super pleasant. Like I everything just seems really perfect right now.

Speaker 1 [00:21:34] Yeah, that's great. I love that. Um, awesome. Okay, that is the end of the scale. So thank you so much for doing that. I know it's sometimes a little bit awkward with, like, the numbers, but yeah, I really appreciate it. So, um, the next question, the next two questions might be a little bit more sensitive or personal. So if you don't feel comfortable sharing your responses, that is totally okay. Just let me know. But we want to know more about like your physical intimacy as a couple. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:22:17] Um. But I don't know. Maybe. Couple of times a week. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:22:30] And how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:22:35] I'm pretty satisfied. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:22:38] And why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:22:41] I'm. I mean, like. She takes care of me when she can. When I would like to be and I try to do the same for her. And like, I don't know, we just said we will take that communication into the bedroom as well. Just what we both want and what we both need at that time.

Speaker 1 [00:23:10] Yeah. That's awesome. Absolutely. Yeah. Great. So we are close to wrapping up. I would just like to summarize what we've conversed about in the past few minutes. And so you are very satisfied with the relationship. You believe that love is quite important in a relationship and that you maintain it primarily through communication. And you believe that this is like the most high quality relationship you've had?

Speaker 2 [00:23:44] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:23:45] Is there anything else that I missed that you would like to add, or just like that I got wrong in my, like, little summary.

Speaker 2 [00:23:54] That sounds about right.

Speaker 1 [00:23:56] Okay. Awesome. And before we end, I want to talk to you about how we're going to handle the data. As a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so I want to know which data option, data sharing option you'd be most comfortable with. So option one is that transcript. Portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. Option two is that if you're bolder, another option is that the whole transcript can be shared. It will be removed of sensitive and overly identifying details so it will be anonymized. Although in this option there's a very minimal chance that someone who knows you very well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down like who among the people they know. But they think that it is. So you will be able to trace it back to you. But it's honestly quite unlikely, although again, no sensitive information will be shared. So of those two options, which are you more comfortable with?

Speaker 2 [00:25:05] Um, yeah, I would. I would be comfortable with, uh, with the second one.

Speaker 1 [00:25:14] Okay. Awesome. Thank you so much. Um, so one last thing before I let you go. We just want to ask about. Recommending other people to be interviewed or to. Nominate people that might know other people that would be interested in being interviewed. Basically, the way that the study is being held is through snowball sampling, which is basically where you ask an interviewee for other potential interviewees and then you interview those and they ask them. And so it's a snowball effect. If that makes sense?

Speaker 2 [00:25:53] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:25:54] But yeah, if you know anyone who might be interested in being interviewed or who would know someone else who would know other people, that makes sense. Like a person who knows a lot of people in relationships who I could reach out to, who would know other people, if that makes sense. But the specific demographic that we're trying to find currently is. People who are in more low satisfaction LGBTQ relationships. So that can be, like people who, like you think argue a lot, or I like fights often or just seem more unhappy, but it is a pretty specific demographic. So if you are

unsure or don't know. Anyone that I told you that is totally. Okay. I just need to ask and I will text all of this to you after this meeting is over so you can have it all in writing. Because I know it was like a lot of information all at once.

Speaker 2 [00:26:54] All right.

Speaker 1 [00:26:55] But yeah, so that was it. Do you have any questions for me or anything you want to say at all? Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:27:02] Okay. I really. No questions. Or anything.

Speaker 1 [00:27:05] No, that's totally valid. No worries at all. Okay. So that it. Thank you so much for doing this interview and for doing it on pretty short notice. So I really do appreciate that. And I know it's really late for you guys, so I really appreciate that as well.

Speaker 2 [00:27:21] Yeah, no problem.

Speaker 1 [00:27:23] So, yeah, thank you so much again. And yeah, I'll reach out to you pretty shortly within like the next day or two long. Just like, watch out for that in case you're interested. But. Yeah. Thank you so much. Yeah. Okay. Thank you. Bye.

Speaker 2 Nice talking to you.